



5-Minute Nighttime Wind-Down Routine

A gentle, no-equipment routine to release tension, slow your breathing, and help your body settle before bed.

1



Slow Breathing With Shoulder Release — 45 seconds

- INSTRUCTION: Sit or stand comfortably. Inhale through your nose, lift your shoulders slightly, then exhale and let them drop.
- FORM CUE: Keep your jaw relaxed and make the exhale longer than the inhale.
- MODIFICATION: Lie on your back with one hand on your chest and one on your belly.

2



Seated Neck and Shoulder Stretch — 45 seconds

- INSTRUCTION: Gently tilt one ear toward one shoulder, then switch sides. Finish with slow shoulder rolls.
- FORM CUE: Keep both shoulders heavy and avoid pulling on your head.
- MODIFICATION: Make the movement smaller if your neck feels sensitive.

3



Cat-Cow — 45 seconds

- INSTRUCTION: On hands and knees, slowly alternate between rounding and gently extending your spine.
- FORM CUE: Move with your breath rather than rushing.
- MODIFICATION: Place your hands on the edge of the bed and perform the same movement standing.

4



Child's Pose With Side Reach — 45 seconds

- INSTRUCTION: Sit your hips back toward your heels, extend your arms forward, then walk both hands slightly to one side and switch.
- FORM CUE: Breathe into your ribs and keep the stretch comfortable.
- MODIFICATION: Place a pillow under your chest or hips.

5



Seated Hamstring Fold — 45 seconds

- INSTRUCTION: Extend one leg, keep the other bent, and hinge forward gently. Switch halfway through.
- FORM CUE: Keep your spine long and stop before you feel strain.
- MODIFICATION: Sit on a pillow or keep the extended knee slightly bent.

6



Figure-Four Glute Stretch — 45 seconds

- INSTRUCTION: Lie on your back, cross one ankle over the opposite thigh, and gently draw the legs toward you. Switch halfway through.
- FORM CUE: Keep your head and shoulders relaxed on the floor.
- MODIFICATION: Perform seated in a chair.

7



Supine Knee Sways — 45 seconds

- INSTRUCTION: Lie on your back with knees bent and feet down. Let both knees move slowly from side to side.
- FORM CUE: Keep the movement easy and let your lower back relax.
- MODIFICATION: Make the range smaller or place a pillow under your knees.

8



Legs-Up Rest — 30 seconds

- INSTRUCTION: Rest your lower legs on the bed, couch, or wall and breathe slowly.
- FORM CUE: Soften your belly and let the floor support you.
- MODIFICATION: Lie flat with a pillow under your knees.



Finish with three slow breaths and remind yourself:
*the goal is not to stretch deeply—
it is to leave your body calmer than you found it.*